

UNIT 5

SECTION A — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks Each)

Basis for Universal Human Values

Q1. What is meant by value-based living?

Answer: Value-based living means living on the basis of right understanding, in which our participation (values) at different levels of our being is naturally expressed — in behaviour (through the values in relationship) and in work (through right utilisation, enrichment and protection of the rest of nature). Values are naturally acceptable to all human beings and conducive to human happiness; value-based living is thus a natural outcome of right understanding, with no gap between what we understand and how we live.

Q2. Name the nine values in human-human relationship (values of behaviour).

Answer: The nine values in relationship are: trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude and love. Trust is the foundation value and love is the complete value. The identification of these values is based on realisation and understanding, and they are naturally acceptable in relationship.

Q3. What are the values of work? What do they result in?

Answer: Working with material things — ensuring their right utilisation, enrichment and protection — is the value of work. It results in prosperity for the human being and preservation (enrichment, protection and right utilisation) of the rest of nature.

Q4. How do universal human values naturally emerge from right understanding?

Answer: There is an innate harmony and orderliness in existence — human beings only need to understand it, not create it. Universal human values are manifestations of the truth of existence, i.e., co-existence, in various dimensions of human participation in the existential order. These values are naturally acceptable to all human beings and conducive to human happiness. Only our ignorance leads to the difficulties and confusions in appreciating and inculcating them.

Q5. What is meant by the 'development of human consciousness'?

Answer: The journey towards right understanding brings a transformation in the human being from 'animal consciousness' to 'human consciousness'. In animal consciousness, we give first priority to physical facility. As we transform to human consciousness, we are able to base our thoughts and activities on right understanding, give relationship a higher priority than physical facility, and identify our physical needs and ensure them through cyclic and mutually enriching production processes, thereby enriching the rest of nature as well.

Q6. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of the individual?

Answer: Transition towards happiness and prosperity; slowly getting rid of the contradictions and conflicts within through self-exploration — and thus getting rid of tension, frustration, depression, one-upmanship and psycho-somatic disorders — facilitating definite human conduct. The feeling of self-regulation reduces the occurrence of diseases and, in turn, the feeling of insecurity, helping the individual lead a more fulfilling life.

Q7. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of the family?

Answer: Value-based living facilitates peace and harmony in the family, with more occurrences of just and fulfilling behaviour, raising the feeling of togetherness and reducing family feuds. People feel prosperous and the feeling to nurture others grows in the families. Such harmonious living also helps reduce the consumerist behaviour in family celebrations like marriages, parties and other social functions.

Q8. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of the society?

Answer: Fearlessness and mutual trust develop in the society; discrimination on the basis of body (gender, age, race), physical facility (wealth, posts) and beliefs (isms, sects) is reduced; and solutions

emerge to problems like terrorism, communalism and international conflicts. The feeling of undividedness surfaces, the fulfilment of the human goal starts getting to the fore in our plans and projects at all levels, and gradually a human order based on trustful relationships emerges.

Q9. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of nature?

Answer: The human order becomes fulfilling for the other three orders of nature. Problems of pollution and resource depletion are handled smoothly when people are able to judge their needs for physical facility appropriately and the mode of fulfilment is eco-friendly. Better methods of farming and production help cut down greenhouse gases, ozone depletion and ecological imbalance; the various species of animals and birds can be saved from extinction and forests can be replenished.

Definitiveness of (Ethical) Human Conduct

Q10. Define definite (ethical) human conduct.

Answer: Definite human conduct is the sum total of the state of harmony within, expressing itself and participating in harmony with the outside world. It emerges naturally out of right understanding and is definite for all time, place and individual.

Q11. How is the harmony in the Self expressed at all levels of our being, and with what outcomes?

Answer: The harmony in the Self is naturally expressed and extended as: harmony at the level of the Self → happiness; harmony of the Self with the Body → health at the level of the body; harmony in the family / human-human relationship → mutual happiness, justice and fearlessness; harmony with the rest of nature → mutual prosperity (prosperity for the human being and preservation of the rest of nature); and harmony with the whole of nature/existence → co-existence (mutual fulfilment).

Q12. Explain the relationship between human values, policy and character.

Answer: (1) **Human values** — the understanding of the role of the human being in existence: with right understanding, we see our natural participation at all levels of being; this participation is definite and forms the basis of ethical human conduct. (2) **Policy** — the thought of how to express (live with) human values: having identified the definite values, they become the guide to our imagination (desire, thought and expectation); the comprehensive analysis of how to live with and express these values is policy — naturally conducive to human welfare and to the welfare of every unit in existence. (3) **Character** — the expression of human values in behaviour, work and participation in the larger order.

Q13. In terms of what is human character expressed?

Answer: Human character is expressed in terms of: (1) chastity in the conjugal (husband-wife) relationship; (2) rightful acquisition and utilization of wealth — by way of labour, using cyclic and mutually enriching production processes; and (3) kindness in behaviour and work — ensuring justice in behaviour and preservation of the rest of nature in work, leading to the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal, while at the same time compensating for the deficiencies created in the past.

Q14. State the qualifications of ethical human conduct.

Answer: (1) Ethical conduct is naturally acceptable to me and does not give rise to conflict within — it is self-satisfying. (2) It is in consonance with the right understanding of reality — the underlying harmony at all levels. (3) It leads to mutual fulfilment with other people and mutual enrichment with the rest of nature. Thus, ethical conduct is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly for all time, place and individual.

Professional Ethics in the Light of Right Understanding

Q15. Define profession in the context of the comprehensive human goal.

Answer: A profession is a mode of participation by human beings in the larger order in pursuance of the comprehensive human goal. The excellence or success of any professional activity is to be judged from this comprehensive point of view only, and not in terms of merely wealth generation. The profession is not only a means of earning one's livelihood, but also a means of one's evolution by appropriate

participation in the larger order — an important activity to authenticate one's understanding, whereby we interact with other human beings and with the rest of nature in a mutually fulfilling manner.

Q16. What is meant by professional ethics?

Answer: Professional ethics can be seen as the code of ethical conduct of the profession. Ethical conduct of a profession implies the right utilization of one's professional skills in the larger order towards the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal.

Q17. State the six salient features characterizing professional ethics.

Answer: (1) Clarity about the comprehensive human goal. (2) Confidence in oneself as well as confidence in the harmony, co-existence and self-regulation prevailing in the entire existence. (3) Competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour. (4) Competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature. (5) Holistic vision about technologies, production systems and management techniques. (6) Understanding of one's social responsibility.

Q18. Enlist the salient categories of unethical practices in the current professional scenario.

Answer: Corruption in multiple forms and at various levels; tax evasion, misappropriation and misuse of public funds; misuse of political power and bureaucratic authority; misleading propaganda, unethical advertisements and sales promotion; cut-throat competition; exploiting the weakness of consumers through various enticements and bewildering advertisements; adulteration and spurious production; endangering the health and safety of the public at large; and hoarding and over-charging. As a result of this 'epidemic' of unethical practices, we frequently come across serious scams, major economic offences and kickbacks in large-scale purchases.

Q19. What approaches are presently employed to check unethical practices, and why are they inadequate?

Answer: The methods presently employed include: promoting awareness about professional ethics through new courses, refresher programs and case studies; administering oaths and prescribing codes of ethical conduct; setting up mechanisms for intensive audit, inspection and monitoring; framing more stringent laws and harder punishments; promoting transparency through mechanisms like RTI; carrying out sting operations and publicising serious lapses through media; encouraging whistle blowing; setting up Lokpals, vigilance commissions, ethics committees, tribunals and consumer protection forums; and filing public interest litigations. Most of these are either of a symptomatic nature, punitive measures or crisis-management techniques — the focus is primarily towards curbing the ill effects rather than rectifying the root cause, namely the faulty world-view which continues to remain dominant.

Q20. How do inherent contradictions and dilemmas arise from the prevailing worldview?

Answer: The prevailing worldview perceives wealth maximization as the prime objective. Thus, the other person's happiness seems to be in conflict with my happiness: the other people have to be exploited for one to gain affluence, and there is no possibility of mutual fulfilment in a sustainable way. In the same way, exploitation of nature also becomes acceptable, as it helps a person accumulate wealth easily, and there is no limit to this.

Q21. What is the way ahead for safeguarding professional ethics?

Answer: To resolve the situation, sincere effort towards building up the ethical competence of human beings in general, and professionals in particular, through proper value education is needed. It can be an effective way to safeguard professional ethics. Clarity of the comprehensive human goal and of our participation in the different dimensions of society will ensure ethics in profession.

A Basis for Humanistic Education, Humanistic Constitution and Universal Human Order

Q22. What is the vision for holistic development?

Answer: In the light of right understanding, it is possible to visualize the pattern of a holistic way of life catering to the comprehensive human goal — a model of human living which is people-friendly and eco-friendly, and therefore sustainable, conducive to fulfilling the basic human aspirations of all human

beings. It will be a mode of living which is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly. There is an urgent need to initiate research and development in this direction, as the present model of living is proving to be increasingly problematic and unsustainable.

Q23. What does the universal human order involve?

Answer: The universal human order will involve: (a) a holistic pattern in all the dimensions of human activity in society — including education, health-self-regulation, production-work, justice-preservation and exchange-storage; and (b) harmonious networking between the basic units and their clusters, successively moving from family order to world family order: Family Order → Family Cluster Order → Village Order → Village Cluster Order → ... → Nation Order → World Family Order. In each of these dimensions, we can visualize a humane system and conceptualise a harmoniously functioning overall system.

Q24. What is humanistic education? What does it facilitate?

Answer: The primary step towards the holistic way of life is to develop right understanding, commitment to live accordingly, and the requisite skills and knowledge systems — which calls for a change in the education system towards humanistic education. Humanistic education facilitates the process of self-exploration, leading to the continuous self-evolution of human beings. It enables the realisation of one's innateness as well as the universality and definitiveness of ethical human conduct, and develops the assurance that only value-based living can be conducive to continuous happiness and prosperity for one and all.

Q25. What is a humanistic constitution? What will be its salient directive principles?

Answer: Right understanding provides the basis for a humanistic constitution, which is essential to the development of an un-fragmented human society and a universal human order. Working towards the comprehensive human goal and developing the competence for ethical human conduct will be among its salient directive principles, and it will be conducive to social justice. To begin with, the family will be the smallest unit of order in the society; moving from family to the world family, the constitution will provide the basis of harmonious living.

Q26. How does humanistic education pave the way towards a humanistic tradition and universal human order?

Answer: Humanistic education leads to human conduct, human constitution and universal human order; and in turn, the universal human order ensures humanistic education for the next generation. The entry point is humanistic education. With suitable systems and policies evolved in the light of right understanding, it is possible to move towards a universal human order, and such a development will be naturally acceptable to all human beings.

Holistic Technologies, Production Systems and Management Models

Q27. Why is there a strong need for a holistic worldview in developing technologies and systems? Critically appraise the prevailing systems.

Answer: Most of the present-day effort in developing innovative technologies and systems is going on under the influence of the materialistic world-view; the holistic world-view is missing. As a result, both the structure and the use/misuse of these innovations is often proving counterproductive, contrary to long-term human welfare. The present-day systems have caused the menace of resource depletion on one hand, and environmental degradation manifesting as pollution and global warming on the other. Other undesirable characteristics of modern technologies and systems include their centralized configurations, promotion of wastefulness, excessive transportation, and the substitution of human, animal and other natural resources by man-made gadgets, machines and materials.

Q28. State the three broad criteria for evaluating holistic technologies and systems.

Answer: (a) Catering to appropriate needs and lifestyles. (b) Eco-friendly — cyclic/renewable and mutually enriching. (c) User-friendly — safe, economical and enhancing human capability. In addition,

these have to promote local self-sufficiency and optimal utilization of local resources and expertise; as far as possible, priority should be for naturally available processes and systems.

Q29. List the specific criteria for judging the appropriateness of technologies.

Answer: Catering to real human needs; compatible with natural systems and cycles; facilitating effective utilization of the human body, animals, plants and other natural materials; safe, user-friendly and conducive to health; producible with local resources and expertise as far as possible; promoting the use of renewable energy resources; low cost and energy efficient; enhancing human interaction and cooperation; promoting decentralisation; and durability, life cycle and recyclability of products.

Q30. What are the four key questions to be answered in determining production systems?

Answer: What to produce? How to produce? For whom to produce? How much to produce? All these are decided in the context of the availability of local natural resources and expertise, to cater to the needs of the people of any given community — with the needs characterised in consonance with the comprehensive human goal.

Q31. List the criteria for judging the appropriateness of production systems.

Answer: Optimal and efficient utilization of local resources and expertise (human beings, animals, air, solar, land, water, bio and mineral resources); economic viability and sustainability; priority for local consumption; matching the pattern of production with the availability/producibility in the local environment and the pattern of consumption; decentralized systems capable of meaningful employment of people in the community; facilitating production by masses, and not mass production in a centralized mode, to the extent possible; promoting individual creativity and sense of accomplishment; using people-friendly and eco-friendly technologies; ensuring requisite quality of production; safe and conducive to the health of persons involved in production as well as others; and harnessing recycling, conservation and reuse possibilities.

Q32. What is meant by a humanistic management model? State its criteria.

Answer: Management models are primarily to be relationship-based, cooperative and ensuring justice in terms of mutual fulfilment — not coercive and exploitative. The criteria for a humanistic management model are: the whole unit working as a well-knit family; cooperative, motivational and mutually fulfilling; ensuring correct appraisal of human labour and skills; targeting employer-employee as well as consumer satisfaction, and not profit maximisation; sharing of responsibility and a participative mode of management; continuous value addition of the persons involved; and effectively integrating individual competencies and complementarity.

Q33. What can we learn from the systems in nature and traditional practices? Give examples.

Answer: To gain insight into holistic systems, we have a lot to learn from the systems in nature and from traditional practices — identifying the eco-friendly and people-friendly characteristics of many traditional practices which are worthy of recognition and retention, and then using present-day information to augment them and make them more effective, efficient and suited to current needs. Significant examples: the water harvesting, storage and utilization systems through ponds; traditional agricultural practices; traditional local remedies and health-care techniques; grain storage and food preservation practices; yoga, ayurveda and naturopathy-based healthcare systems; the langar (sharing of food) system prevalent in religious institutions; family-based rural enterprises; the jajmani system (relationship-based village system ensuring rural self-sufficiency); and rural craft and artisanal practices.

Q34. What is meant by visualizing a holistic community model (gram-swarajya)? Name the salient topics for case studies.

Answer: It is high time to start working for the actualization of the model of human order at the village level (gram-swarajya) in the light of right understanding. Several groups have started working in this direction and many technologies and systems have been evolved, though the full-scale demonstration of such alternative ways of living is yet to emerge. Salient topics for case studies: (1) renewable and decentralized energy technologies — biomass-based energy conversion systems, gadgets and

implements for efficient utilization of human muscle power and animal draught power, decentralized wind power, and micro hydel electro-mechanical power generation; (2) systems for water conservation and watershed management for efficient utilization of rain water and eco-restoration; (3) technologies and architecture promoting green building materials and energy conservation; (4) organic/natural farming techniques; (5) eco-sanitation techniques for small-scale decentralized sewage disposal and waste water recycling; (6) low-cost and energy-efficient technologies for small-scale production systems; and (7) humanistic organizational/management models.

Strategies for Transition towards Value-based Life and Profession

Q35. State the core message of the course.

Answer: To be able to fulfil the basic human aspirations — happiness and prosperity, and their continuity — it is essential to gain the right understanding: the understanding about oneself vis-à-vis the rest of existence, and the understanding about continuous happiness and prosperity. This involves the realisation that there is an innate harmony at all levels of existence — the whole existence is co-existence. It is the essential purpose of human beings to understand this harmony and co-existence, and learn to live in accordance with it and be fulfilled.

Q36. What two transformations does the core message of the course lead to?

Answer: (1) **Individual transformation** — from animal consciousness to human consciousness. (2) **Societal transformation** — from inhuman society to humane society.

Q37. State the three sub-steps for individual transformation (Step 1).

Answer: (1) Verify the proposals on your own right — on the basis of your natural acceptance and on the basis of your experiential validation. (2) Be aware of yourself, and of your imagination (desire, thought and expectation) every moment — with this awareness, you know the content of your imagination and of all the accumulated acceptances which are your sanskar. (3) Self-evaluation — evaluate your sanskar vis-à-vis your natural acceptance. Recall: $\text{sanskar}(t) + \text{environment}(t) + \text{self-exploration}(t) \rightarrow \text{sanskar}(t+1)$. These sub-steps may take a long time, but each proposal that you are able to verify and bring into your living will be immediately fulfilling for you and for those around you.

Q38. Whom should you share with, and how, while creating mass awareness towards holistic development (Step 2)?

Answer: With right understanding and right feeling in you, you develop the willingness and capacity to share with others — facilitating and developing other people to have the right understanding, right feeling and right thought — in the form of informal talks and formal workshops. The people to share with include: family members and friends; people who have interest and readiness for purposeful social effort and social development; educators, teachers and education administrators; people connected to governance; and colleagues at work. To start with, it is important to share only with those who are already willing to listen — if you start this step before you have done sufficient work on yourself, people may not be able to accept you as a preceptor.

Q39. State the sub-steps for moving towards humanising the mainstream education (Step 3).

Answer: (1) Integrating appropriate inputs of value education at various levels in the current curricula, from school education to higher education. (2) Requisite support and policy initiatives by monitoring agencies such as MHRD, UGC, AICTE, ICMR, University Academic Councils and School Education Boards. (3) Introducing teacher orientation programs (faculty development programs) and developing resource material to implement the effort at a large scale. (4) Providing adequate thrust to R&D; dedicated towards transforming the whole mainstream education into humanistic (value-based) education — a long-drawn process, but indispensable.

Q40. What does developing models for holistic living involve (Step 4)?

Answer: Developing models for holistic living in educational institutions and in the community — linking the educational institutions with local development programs, in collaboration with voluntary

organisations and government agencies. Accordingly, the focus of R&D; in higher education institutions will need to be shifted towards the various aspects of holistic development, resulting in the development of real-life models facilitating the universal human order.

SECTION B — Long/Descriptive Answer Questions (7 Marks Each)

Basis for Universal Human Values and Value-based Living

Q1. Explain how universal human values emerge naturally from right understanding, distinguishing between values of behaviour and values of work, and describe the development of human consciousness along with the implications of value-based living at the levels of the individual, family, society and nature.

Answer: Basis in right understanding: based on our understanding of harmony, we participate in the larger order, and our participation at different levels is our value — identified on the basis of realisation and understanding. There is an innate harmony and orderliness in existence; human beings only need to understand it, not create it. Universal human values are manifestations of the truth of existence — co-existence — in various dimensions of human participation in the existential order. They are naturally acceptable to all and conducive to happiness; only our ignorance creates difficulties in appreciating and inculcating them.

Values of behaviour and values of work: the participation of the human being is in the form of behaviour and work. The values of behaviour are the nine values in relationship — trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude and love (trust the foundation value, love the complete value). The values of work are right utilisation, enrichment and protection of material things — resulting in prosperity for the human being and preservation of the rest of nature.

Development of human consciousness: the journey towards right understanding transforms the human being from 'animal consciousness' (first priority to physical facility) to 'human consciousness' (thoughts and activities based on right understanding, relationship given higher priority than physical facility, physical needs identified and ensured through cyclic and mutually enriching production processes, enriching the rest of nature as well).

Implications of value-based living:

At the level of the individual: transition towards happiness and prosperity; getting rid of contradictions and conflicts within through self-exploration — ridding oneself of tension, frustration, depression, one-upmanship and psycho-somatic disorders — facilitating definite human conduct; the feeling of self-regulation reduces diseases and insecurity, leading to a more fulfilling life.

At the level of the family: peace and harmony, more just and fulfilling behaviour, greater togetherness, fewer family feuds; people feel prosperous and the feeling to nurture others grows; consumerist behaviour in celebrations reduces.

At the level of the society: fearlessness and mutual trust; reduction of discrimination on the basis of body, physical facility and beliefs; solutions to terrorism, communalism and international conflicts; the feeling of undividedness; the human goal coming to the fore in plans and projects, and a human order based on trustful relationships gradually emerging.

At the level of nature: the human order becomes fulfilling for the other three orders; pollution and resource depletion handled smoothly; eco-friendly fulfilment of appropriately-judged needs; better farming and production cutting down greenhouse gases, ozone depletion and ecological imbalance; species saved from extinction and forests replenished.

Definitiveness of (Ethical) Human Conduct

Q2. Explain the definitiveness of ethical human conduct — how harmony is expressed at all levels of being, how ethical conduct is grasped in terms of values, policy and character, and the

qualifications of ethical conduct.

Answer: Definition: definite human conduct is the sum total of the state of harmony within, expressing itself and participating in harmony with the outside world. It emerges naturally out of right understanding and is definite for all time, place and individual.

Expression at all levels of being: harmony at the level of the Self → happiness; harmony of the Self with the Body → health; harmony in the family / human-human relationship → mutual happiness, justice and fearlessness; harmony with the rest of nature → mutual prosperity (prosperity for the human being and preservation of the rest of nature); harmony with the whole of nature/existence → co-existence (mutual fulfilment).

Values, policy and character: (1) **Human values** — the understanding of the role of the human being in existence: with right understanding we see our definite natural participation at all levels of being, which forms the basis of ethical human conduct. (2) **Policy** — the thought of how to express and live with these values: they guide our imagination (desire, thought and expectation); the comprehensive analysis of how to live with them is policy — conducive to the enrichment, protection and right utilization of self, body and physical resources, and to the welfare of every unit in existence. (3) **Character** — the expression of human values in behaviour, work and participation in the larger order, expressed as: chastity in the conjugal (husband-wife) relationship; rightful acquisition and utilization of wealth by way of labour, using cyclic and mutually enriching production processes; and kindness in behaviour and work — ensuring justice in behaviour and preservation of the rest of nature in work, leading to the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal while compensating for deficiencies created in the past.

Qualifications of ethical conduct: it is naturally acceptable to me and does not give rise to conflict within (self-satisfying); it is in consonance with the right understanding of reality — the underlying harmony at all levels; and it leads to mutual fulfilment with other people and mutual enrichment with the rest of nature. Thus ethical conduct is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly for all time, place and individual.

Professional Ethics in the Light of Right Understanding

Q3. Explain professional ethics in the light of right understanding — the meaning of profession, the definition and salient features of professional ethics, the issues in the current scenario, the inadequacy of the prevailing approaches, the inherent contradictions, and the way ahead.

Answer: Profession in the context of the comprehensive human goal: a profession is a mode of participation by human beings in the larger order in pursuance of the comprehensive human goal. Its excellence or success is to be judged from this comprehensive point of view, not merely in terms of wealth generation. The profession is not only a means of earning one's livelihood but also a means of one's evolution by appropriate participation in the larger order — an important activity to authenticate one's understanding, interacting with other human beings and the rest of nature in a mutually fulfilling manner.

Professional ethics: the code of ethical conduct of the profession — implying the right utilization of one's professional skills in the larger order towards the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal.

Salient features: (1) clarity about the comprehensive human goal; (2) confidence in oneself and in the harmony, co-existence and self-regulation prevailing in entire existence; (3) competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour; (4) competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature; (5) holistic vision about technologies, production systems and management techniques; (6) understanding of one's social responsibility.

Issues in the current scenario: unethical practices are rapidly increasing and their impact is far-reaching — serious scams, major economic offences, kickbacks in large-scale purchases. The

salient categories: corruption; tax evasion, misappropriation and misuse of public funds; misuse of political power and bureaucratic authority; misleading propaganda and unethical advertisements; cut-throat competition; exploiting the weakness of consumers; adulteration and spurious production; endangering public health and safety; hoarding and over-charging.

Prevailing approaches and their inadequacy: ethics courses and case studies; oaths and codes of conduct; audit and monitoring; stringent laws and harder punishments; transparency mechanisms like RTI; sting operations and media publicity; whistle blowing; Lokpals, vigilance commissions, ethics committees, tribunals, consumer forums; public interest litigations. Most of these are symptomatic, punitive or crisis-management measures — focused on curbing the ill effects rather than rectifying the root cause: the faulty world-view that remains dominant.

Inherent contradictions: in the prevailing worldview of wealth maximization, the other person's happiness seems to be in conflict with my happiness — others have to be exploited for one to gain affluence, with no possibility of sustainable mutual fulfilment; exploitation of nature also becomes acceptable for accumulating wealth, with no limit to it.

The way ahead: sincere effort towards building up the ethical competence of human beings in general and professionals in particular, through proper value education — an effective way to safeguard professional ethics.

Humanistic Education, Humanistic Constitution and Universal Human Order

Q4. Explain the vision for holistic development and universal human order, and show how humanistic education and humanistic constitution form the basis for moving towards it.

Answer: Vision for holistic development: right understanding enables the visualization of the comprehensive human goal and a holistic way of life catering to it — a model of living that is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly, and therefore sustainable and conducive to fulfilling the basic human aspirations of all. There is an urgent need for R&D; in this direction, as the present model of living is proving increasingly problematic and unsustainable.

Universal human order: it will involve (a) a holistic pattern in all dimensions of human activity in society — education, health-self-regulation, production-work, justice-preservation and exchange-storage; and (b) harmonious networking between the basic units and their clusters, successively from Family Order → Family Cluster Order → Village Order → Village Cluster Order → ... → Nation Order → World Family Order. In each dimension we can visualize a humane system and conceptualise a harmoniously functioning overall system.

Humanistic education: the primary step towards the holistic way of life is to develop right understanding, commitment to live accordingly, and the requisite skills and knowledge systems — calling for a change in the education system. Humanistic education facilitates self-exploration, leading to continuous self-evolution; it enables the realisation of one's innateness as well as the universality and definitiveness of ethical human conduct; and it develops the assurance that only value-based living is conducive to continuous happiness and prosperity for one and all.

Humanistic constitution: right understanding also provides the basis for a humanistic constitution, essential to the development of an un-fragmented human society and a universal human order. Working towards the comprehensive human goal and developing the competence for ethical human conduct will be among its salient directive principles, and it will be conducive to social justice. The family will be the smallest unit of order; moving from family to the world family, the constitution will provide the basis of harmonious living. Thought-provoking issues to address include: what the fundamental rights and duties will be, how justice and protection will be ensured, the format of working for a universal human order,

how people will connect to the world family, and how the representation of people will be ensured in maintaining order in society.

The chain: humanistic education leads to human conduct, human constitution, universal human order; and in turn, the universal human order ensures humanistic education for the next generation. The entry point is humanistic education — with suitable systems and policies evolved in the light of right understanding, it is possible to move towards the universal human order, which will be naturally acceptable to all human beings.

Holistic Technologies, Production Systems and Management Models

Q5. Explain the need for a holistic worldview in developing technologies and systems, the three broad criteria for their evaluation, and the specific criteria for technologies, production systems and management models. Also discuss what we can learn from the systems in nature and traditional practices, and the vision of a holistic community model (gram-swarajya).

Answer: Need for a holistic worldview: most present-day innovation proceeds under the influence of the materialistic worldview — the holistic world-view is missing. As a result, both the structure and the use/misuse of these innovations is often counterproductive, contrary to long-term human welfare: resource depletion, environmental degradation (pollution, global warming), centralized configurations, promotion of wastefulness, excessive transportation, and substitution of human, animal and natural resources by man-made gadgets. Hence there is a strong need to develop technologies and systems with holistic objectives governed by right understanding.

Three broad criteria for evaluation: (a) catering to appropriate needs and lifestyles; (b) eco-friendly — cyclic/renewable and mutually enriching; (c) user-friendly — safe, economical and enhancing human capability — in addition promoting local self-sufficiency and optimal utilization of local resources and expertise, with priority for naturally available processes and systems.

Criteria for technologies: catering to real human needs; compatible with natural systems and cycles; facilitating effective utilization of the human body, animals, plants and natural materials; safe, user-friendly and conducive to health; producible with local resources and expertise; promoting renewable energy; low cost and energy efficient; enhancing human interaction and cooperation; promoting decentralisation; durability, life cycle and recyclability.

Criteria for production systems: the four key questions — what to produce, how to produce, for whom to produce, how much to produce — are decided in the context of local resources and expertise, with needs characterised in consonance with the comprehensive human goal. Specific criteria: optimal utilization of local resources and expertise; economic viability and sustainability; priority for local consumption; matching production patterns with local availability and consumption; decentralized systems capable of meaningful employment; production by masses rather than mass production; promoting individual creativity and sense of accomplishment; people-friendly and eco-friendly technologies; requisite quality; safety and health; harnessing recycling, conservation and reuse.

Criteria for management models: relationship-based, cooperative and ensuring justice in terms of mutual fulfilment — not coercive and exploitative: the whole unit working as a well-knit family; cooperative, motivational and mutually fulfilling; correct appraisal of human labour and skills; employer-employee and consumer satisfaction rather than profit maximisation; sharing of responsibility and participative management; continuous value addition of the persons involved; and integrating individual competencies and complementarity.

Learning from nature and traditional practices: water harvesting systems through ponds; traditional agricultural practices; local remedies and health-care techniques; grain storage and food preservation;

yoga, ayurveda and naturopathy-based healthcare; the langar system; family-based rural enterprises; the jajmani system; rural craft and artisanal practices — identifying their eco-friendly and people-friendly characteristics worthy of recognition and retention, and augmenting them with present-day information.

Holistic community model (gram-swarajya): working for the actualization of the model of human order at the village level, with dedicated R&D; efforts within the framework of right understanding. Salient topics for case studies include: renewable and decentralized energy technologies (biomass, human muscle and animal draught power gadgets, decentralized wind, micro hydel); water conservation and watershed management; green building materials and energy conservation; organic/natural farming; eco-sanitation and waste water recycling; low-cost, energy-efficient small-scale production systems; and humanistic organizational/management models.

Strategies for Transition towards Value-based Life and Profession

Q6. State the core message of the course, and explain the strategies (four steps) for the transition towards a value-based life and profession, leading to the universal human order.

Answer: The core message: to fulfil the basic human aspirations — happiness and prosperity with continuity — it is essential to gain right understanding about oneself vis-à-vis the rest of existence and about continuous happiness and prosperity. This involves the realisation that there is an innate harmony at all levels of existence — the whole existence is co-existence — and that it is the essential purpose of human beings to understand this harmony and live in accordance with it. This leads to individual transformation (from animal consciousness to human consciousness) and societal transformation (from inhuman society to humane society).

Step 1 — Individual transformation: (1) verify the proposals on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance and experiential validation; (2) be aware of yourself and of your imagination (desire, thought and expectation) every moment — knowing the content of your imagination and your accumulated acceptances (sanskar); (3) self-evaluation — evaluate your sanskar vis-à-vis your natural acceptance. Recall: $\text{sanskar}(t) + \text{environment}(t) + \text{self-exploration}(t) \rightarrow \text{sanskar}(t+1)$. Each proposal verified and brought into living is immediately fulfilling for you and those around you.

Step 2 — Creating mass awareness towards holistic development: with right understanding and right feeling, develop the willingness and capacity to share with others — through informal talks and formal workshops — with family members and friends, people ready for purposeful social effort, educators and education administrators, people connected to governance, and colleagues at work. To start with, share only with those already willing to listen.

Step 3 — Moving towards humanising the mainstream education: (1) integrating appropriate inputs of value education at various levels of the current curricula, from school to higher education; (2) support and policy initiatives by monitoring agencies such as MHRD, UGC, AICTE, ICMR, University Academic Councils and School Education Boards; (3) teacher orientation programs (faculty development programs) and development of resource material; (4) an adequate thrust to R&D; dedicated to transforming mainstream education into humanistic (value-based) education — long-drawn but indispensable.

Step 4 — Developing models for holistic living: developing models in educational institutions and in the community, linking institutions with local development programs in collaboration with voluntary organisations and government agencies, and shifting the focus of R&D; in higher education towards aspects of holistic development — resulting in real-life models facilitating the universal human order.

Conclusion: to ensure happiness and prosperity with continuity for all human beings, the transition to human consciousness and a humane society is essential — requiring a dedicated effort to implement,

at a mass scale, humanistic education focusing on right understanding.